

20 BELOW



QUICK REFERENCE GUIDE

20 BELOW

HOW 20 BELOW WORKS

1

THE WORLD PRESENTS A PROBLEM

The GM sets the scene. Something stands in your way, or calls you to act.

2

CHOOSE YOUR APPROACH

Decide how your character meets it, and which Element that approach uses.

3

CALCULATE YOUR TARGET

Target number = that Element's Attribute + the Difficulty the GM sets.

4

ROLL 2D10

Roll two ten-sided dice and add them together.

5

COMPARE ROLL TO TARGET

Equal to or under the target succeeds. Over it fails. A 2 always succeeds, a 20 always fails.

6

DETERMINE THE OUTCOME

The result tells you what happens, and how the world changes.

7

THE STORY CONTINUES

Face the consequences. Play on.

FIVE ELEMENTS. INFINITE OUTCOMES.

20 BELOW

CORE ROLL CHEAT SHEET

ROLL UNDER

1

TARGET NUMBER

Attribute + Difficulty. Nothing else goes into it.
Range 1 to 20. Difficulty 0 is nearly impossible, 10 is trivial.
No applicable Skill? Target is the Difficulty alone.

2

ROLL UNDER

Roll 2d10 and add them together.
Equal to or LOWER than the target succeeds. Higher fails.
Lower is always better. This is backwards from most games.

3

CRITICALS

A roll of 2 - both dice show 1 - is a critical success.
A roll of 20 - both dice show 10 - is a catastrophic failure.
Both apply no matter what the target number is.

4

ADVANTAGE & DISADVANTAGE

Advantage: roll 3d10, keep the LOWEST two.
Disadvantage: roll 3d10, keep the HIGHEST two.
Count sources: +1 per Advantage, -1 per Disadvantage.
1 or more = Advantage. 0 = normal. Below 0 = Disadvantage.

5

TRAINING TIERS

0 UNTRAINED	Difficulty only - the Attribute does not apply
1 TRAINED	Straight roll
2 ADEPT	Advantage
3 EXPERT	Advantage, and critical success on a 2 or 3
4 MASTER	As Expert, plus reroll a catastrophic failure

6

FATE TOKENS

Automatic Success - spend 1 token, the roll succeeds outright. No dice.
Voluntary Disadvantage - take Disadvantage on a roll, earn 1 token.
Flat 1 token either way, whatever the Difficulty.

ROLL LOW. FATE ANSWERS WHEN YOU ACT.

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BELOW

ADVANTAGE & DISADVANTAGE

ONE MORE DIE, AND YOU KEEP TWO

1 THREE DICE, KEEP TWO

Lower is better, so Advantage keeps your lowest two and Disadvantage your highest two.

ADVANTAGE
3d10

KEEP THE LOWEST TWO

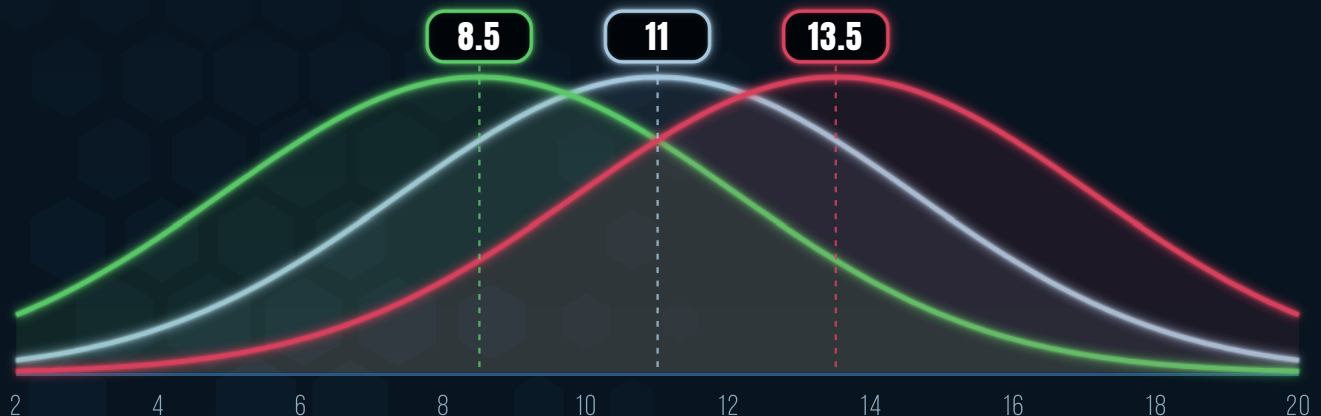
NORMAL
2d10

KEEP BOTH

DISADVANTAGE
3d10

KEEP THE HIGHEST TWO

2 WHERE THE ROLL LANDS



LOWER IS BETTER. AN EXTRA DIE SLIDES THE WHOLE CURVE TOWARD OR AWAY FROM YOU.

3 WHAT IT DOES TO YOUR CHANCES

The chance to succeed at the same target number, three ways.

TARGET 8

ADV	53%
NORMAL	28%
DIS	11%

TARGET 11

ADV	79%
NORMAL	55%
DIS	29%

TARGET 14

ADV	93%
NORMAL	79%
DIS	57%

4 COUNT THE SOURCES

+1 for each Advantage, -1 for each Disadvantage.

1 or more is Advantage. 0 is a normal roll. Below 0 is Disadvantage.

ONE MORE DIE MOVES THE CENTRE TWO AND A HALF POINTS.

20 BELOW DIFFICULTY CHART

HOW HARD IT IS, AND WHAT TO ROLL

TARGET NUMBER
ATTRIBUTE + DIFFICULTY

ROLL 2D10
EQUAL OR UNDER SUCCEEDS

UNTRAINED
DIFFICULTY ALONE

DIFFICULTY

EXAMPLES

0

NEARLY IMPOSSIBLE

Beyond normal reach. Takes luck, a miracle, or something truly special.

- Catch an arrow out of the air mid-flight
- Guess a secret from a guarded mind
- Survive a direct hit from heavy ordnance

1

EXTREMELY HARD

Extraordinary odds. Possible only with great skill or a major advantage.

- Pick a masterwork lock with no tools, blindfolded
- Climb a vertical cliff without gear
- Hack an encrypted system with no access

2

VERY HARD

Long odds. Requires real skill, resources, or favorable conditions.

- Scale a sheer, rain-slicked cliff face
- Disarm a complex trap
- Spot a hidden camera

3

HARD

Unlikely. Requires good skill or the right circumstances.

- Convince a hostile guard captain to stand down
- Pick a high-security lock
- Find one specific item in a crowded room

4

CHALLENGING

A real test. Possible with effort, focus, and the right tools or support.

- Track a careful quarry through a rainstorm
- Climb a building in bad weather
- Diagnose an obscure illness

5

MODERATE

Doable. A solid chance with normal effort and conditions.

- A tense but ordinary skill check under pressure
- Pick a standard lock
- Repair basic equipment

6

FAIRLY EASY

Likely. Ordinary competence and the right tools see it through.

- Pick a simple lock with the right tools
- Persuade a neutral NPC
- Find the right information

7

EASY

Comfortable. Requires little effort or special skill.

- Climb a sturdy rope with knots tied in it
- Notice something obvious
- Climb a short wall

8

VERY EASY

Almost certain. Only a small chance of failure.

- Recall a well-known fact in your field
- Spot a large object
- Climb a waist-high barrier

9

NEARLY TRIVIAL

Barely a test. Failure takes something going badly wrong.

- Walk a straight line on level ground
- Open an unlocked door
- Notice something in plain view

10

TRIVIAL

Routine. Succeeds without meaningful effort.

- Tie your own shoes
- Stand up
- Use a simple, everyday tool

0 IS NEARLY IMPOSSIBLE AND 10 IS TRIVIAL. THE HIGHER THE DIFFICULTY, THE EASIER THE ROLL.

20 BELOW TIME

HOW LONG, AND WHAT COMES BACK

1 THE TIME BANDS

Every duration in the rules is one of these. If a rule names none, it means Rounds.

ROUND
ABOUT 6 SEC

MINUTE
10 ROUNDS

HOURL
60 MINUTES

SCENE
A SITUATION

DAY
24 HOURS

WEEK
7 DAYS

MONTH

YEAR

DECADE

CENTURY

2 WHAT HAPPENS ON EACH BAND

ROUND

Bleeding: 1 die vs Soak. On fire: 2 dice. No air: Stamina rounds, then 1 Health.

MINUTE

In cold water: 1 Exhausted per minute.

HOURL

Cold and heat: 1 Exhausted per hour or half hour. A Short Rest.

SCENE

Stamina + 1 counted Fate spends. Frightened, Flustered end.

DAY

Sunrise Token. Night's Rest. Venom roll. Corruption fades. Gifts heal 1 scar Level.

WEEK

Talking Down or Taking the Edge Off heals 1 Mental scar Level.

MONTH

Medicine, Psychology or Networking heals 1 scar Level.

3 RESTS: HOW MUCH COMES BACK

Halves round up, minimum 1. Only one Short Rest counts between Full Night's Rests.

Rest never clears Envenomed, or Exhausted taken from a place you're still in.

SHORT REST

ABOUT 1 HOUR

HEALTH

HEALTH ÷ 2

POISE

PRESENCE ÷ 2

SANITY

PSYCHE ÷ 2

KI

KLOTHO

EXHAUSTED

-1 LEVEL

BELOW 0 HEALTH

NOTHING

FULL NIGHT'S REST

A FULL NIGHT'S SLEEP

ALL OF IT

ALL OF IT

ALL OF IT

ALL OF IT

CLEARED

1 HEALTH LEVEL

4 SUSTAINED EXERTION

Holding your breath, marching, hard labor, running flat out.

FREE FOR STAMINA UNITS

ROUNDS, MINUTES OR HOURS



THEN WATER + DIFFICULTY

ONCE PER EXTRA UNIT



FAIL: +1 EXHAUSTED

EACH CHECK 1 DIFFICULTY HARDER

20
BELOW

CHARACTER CREATION

FIFTEEN STEPS

WHO THEY ARE

☐ 1 NAME

Purely cosmetic. No mechanical weight, and it touches no other step.

☐ 2 CONCEPT

A few words you could say out loud to describe them. Not a backstory.

☐ 3 NATURE

A short archetype. Play to it at a dramatic moment to earn a Fate Token.

THE NUMBERS

☐ 6 DESCRIPTORS

One per point spent in step 5. A one or two-word flavour for that sub-stat.

☐ 5 SUB-STATS

Each Attribute gives points equal to its rating. Split between its two.

☐ 4 ATTRIBUTES

Five, one per Element. All start at 1 free. Spend 20 points, max 10 each.

WHAT THEY DO

☐ 7 SKILLS

Everyman Skills free at Trained. Then spend a 15-point Skills Pool.

☐ 8 BOONS

10-point pool. Trivial 1, Lesser 3, Greater 5, Legendary 7.

☐ 9 RESOURCES

6-point pool, a flat 1 per level. The material and logistical side.

POWER & COST

☐ 12 DISCRETIONARY

10 flat, plus Flaw points, unspent Boons 1:1 and unspent Gifts 2:1.

☐ 11 FLAWS

Optional. Each lists its own value, and those points feed step 12.

☐ 10 GIFTS

21-point pool. Every Gift Level costs a flat 3 points.

READY TO PLAY

☐ 13 EQUIPMENT

Buy starting gear from the catalog against your creation-Wealth.

☐ 14 FIGURED

Computed, not bought. Health 5+Health, Poise 5+Presence, Ki top Element +8.

☐ 15 FINISHING TOUCHES

The character is ready to play. Check the sheet over and begin.

MOST OF THESE TAKE SECONDS. TICK AS YOU GO.

20 BELOW

ELEMENTS AND SUB-STATS

WHAT EVERY NUMBER ON YOUR SHEET DOES

Each Attribute rolls at its full rating, and splits that same number between its two sub-stats, for good. Every point in a sub-stat earns one Descriptor, which can argue a Skill onto that Element.

EARTH

FORCE

Physical power and endurance.

SOAK

Your wall against Physical dice. Each die over it costs a Health Level.

POTENCE

Carry Potence² x 10 kg. Break anything whose Hardness is at or under it. Sets the dice for Grab, Disarm and Bulldoze.

AIR

PRECISION

Agility, adaptability and intellect.

INITIATIVE

1d10 + Initiative, rolled once when a fight starts. Higher acts first.

PSYCHE

Your wall against Mental dice. Social Defense is 10 - Psyche; Sanity is 5 + Psyche. Ki adds it to a Mental die.

FIRE

INTENSITY

Drive and aggression.

FEROCITY

1 Ki adds it to a Physical attack die. It powers a Gift's Physical attack dice too.

PRESENCE

Your wall against Social dice. Mental Defense is 10 - Presence; Poise is 5 + Presence. Ki adds it to a Social die.

WATER

ADAPTATION

Perception and empathy.

STAMINA

Hold Stamina x 3 + 1 Fate Tokens; make Stamina + 1 counted spends a Scene. Stamina units of any exertion are free.

HEALTH

Health Levels are 5 + Health. A Short Rest heals Health ÷ 2, rounded up.

MOIRA

FATE

Fate, destiny and the supernatural. Never a Physical attack.

ATROPOS

Physical Defense is 10 - Atropos. Atropos + Difficulty holds your focus when Distracted.

KLOTHO

Your lucky number: a core roll totalling it earns a Fate Token. A Short Rest restores Klotho Ki; a critical adds it to each rolled die.

FIGURED, NOT BOUGHT

WORKED OUT FROM WHAT YOU CHOSE

HEALTH LEVELS

5 + Health

POISE

5 + Presence

SANITY

5 + Psyche

KI

Top Element + 8

MOVEMENT

5 + Air, in m

CARRY

Potence² x 10 kg

PHYSICAL DEFENSE

10 - Atropos

SOCIAL DEFENSE

10 - Psyche

MENTAL DEFENSE

10 - Presence

A WALL STOPS DICE. A DEFENSE STOPS THE HIT. NO SUB-STAT DOES BOTH FOR THE SAME ATTACK.

20 BELOW SKILLS

WHAT TRAINING BUYS YOU

1 TRAINING TIERS

ONE TIER AT A TIME, NO SKIPPING

TIER	THE ROLL	SOCIAL DICE	POINTS, TOTAL	XP, THIS STEP
0 UNTRAINED	Difficulty only. Your Attribute doesn't count.	1	-	-
1 TRAINED	Attribute + Difficulty.	3	1	3
2 ADEPT	Attribute + Difficulty, at Advantage.	4	2	2
3 EXPERT	As Adept, and a 2 or 3 is a critical success.	5	3	4
4 MASTER	As Expert, and a catastrophic failure gets one reroll.	6	4	6

Creation: a 15-point Skills Pool, 1 point for every tier climbed. Advancement: a new Skill costs 3 XP, then your current tier x 2 - Untrained to Master is 15 XP.

2 EVERYMAN SKILLS

TRAINED, FOR FREE

Every character has these at Trained without spending a point. The GM sets the list for the campaign, and Perception is always on it. A modern-day list:

ATHLETICS

BUREAUCRACY

COMPUTER USE

COOKING

DRIVING

ETIQUETTE

FIRST AID

PERCEPTION

PERSUASION

STREETWISE

3 WEAPON SKILLS

WHAT YOU CAN PICK UP

Never rolled to attack: a to-hit is your Element against their Defense, the same for everyone. The tier says which weapon Categories you can use, and each tier adds to the ones below it.

	MELEE WEAPONS	FIREARMS	ARCHERY	THROWN WEAPONS
1 TRAINED	Improvised, Knife, One-handed blunt, Large blade	Handgun, Shotgun	Hand crossbow, Crossbow	Balanced blade, Thrown axe
2 ADEPT	One-handed blade	Submachine gun	Recurve bow	Shafted
3 EXPERT	Polearm / two-handed, Two-handed, Two-handed blunt	Rifle	Compound bow	Returning
4 MASTER	Exotic (melee)	Heavy	Warbow	Sling

Unarmed needs no Skill: fighting that way is the Onslaught Gift. Exotic ranged weapons come only from the Special Weapons Boon.

EVERY SKILL HAS A DEFAULT ELEMENT. ONE OF YOUR DESCRIPTORS CAN ARGUE ANOTHER, FOR ONE ROLL.
THE GM HAS THE FINAL SAY, AND THE DEFAULT NEVER CHANGES.

20 BELOW

ELEMENTS * SKILLS

WHAT YOU ARE MADE OF * WHAT YOU HAVE ACTUALLY DONE

HOW THIS WORKS

Every Skill starts on a default Element - the ringed cell in each column below.
You may challenge that default, but only with a Sub-Stat Descriptor you already have,
and the argument is made fresh every roll. It never becomes permanent.

	ATHLETICS	ACROBATICS	INTIMIDATION	STEALTH	INVESTIGATION
EARTH FORCE	DEFAULT Power through it.	Muscle the landing.	Loom. Be the wall.	Still as stone.	Turn over every stone.
AIR PRECISION	Time the movement.	DEFAULT Read the gap, take it.	Name what they fear.	Move on the beat.	Reason it through.
FIRE INTENSITY	Refuse to stop.	Commit, no hesitation.	DEFAULT Burn straight at them.	Bold, like you belong.	Press until it cracks.
WATER ADAPTATION	Pace it, outlast it.	Flow with the fall.	Find the soft place.	DEFAULT Match the room.	Feel what is off.
MOIRA FATE	The footing holds.	The gap was always there.	Say the thing they dread.	Nobody happens to look.	DEFAULT The clue finds you.

NO DESCRIPTOR THAT FITS, NO CHALLENGE - THE ROLL USES THE DEFAULT.

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ONE SKILL, FIVE ELEMENTS

START ON THE DEFAULT. ARGUE YOUR WAY OFF IT.

INTIMIDATION

EARTH

FORCE

AIR

PRECISION

FIRE

INTENSITY

WATER

ADAPTATION

MOIRA

FATE

DEFAULT

SOLID: THE DEFAULT, NO ARGUMENT NEEDED. DASHED: THE ELEMENTS YOU HAVE TO ARGUE FOR.

1 START ON THE DEFAULT

Every Skill has one: the most natural way that Skill gets used.
Roll it, and there is nothing to argue. Intimidation starts on Fire.

2 CHALLENGE IT WITH A DESCRIPTOR

Point to a Sub-Stat Descriptor your character already has. It has to fit the moment, and the GM has the final say. No Descriptor that fits, no challenge.

FOR EXAMPLE

"I'm not threatening him. I'm just Hulking over him."

HULKING IS A POTENCE DESCRIPTOR. POTENCE IS EARTH. THE ROLL MOVES TO EARTH.

EARTH

3 ONE ROLL, NOT A RULING

The challenge holds for the roll in front of you and nothing else.
Next time, argue it again. It may not hold up in a different situation.
The Skill's default never changes.

THE DEFAULT IS WHERE A ROLL STARTS, NOT WHERE IT HAS TO STAY.

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THE FATE TRIANGLE

WHERE THE THUMB ON THE SCALE COMES FROM

NATURE

COMES FROM

Chosen at creation.

TO PRESS IT

Play to it when it costs you.

YOU GET

1 Fate Token.

FATE TOKENS

COMES FROM

Nature, Flaws, milestones.

TO PRESS IT

Spend. Held to Stamina $\times 3 + 1$.

YOU GET

The roll, or the fiction, bent.

EARNS A TOKEN

1 TOKEN
REFILLS IT

NO ROUTE BACK

KI

COMES FROM

Strongest Element + 8.

TO PRESS IT

Spend. Refills on a rest.

YOU GET

Preserve, bump, or boost.

WHAT ONE TOKEN BUYS

Automatic Success - a roll succeeds outright, no dice, whatever the Difficulty.

Overcome a Flaw, Shrug Off an Effect, Refill Ki, or Get Back Up from Dying at 1.

Or Kotodama: state a fact and spend to make the fiction true. Cost is Magnitude + Range + Plausibility, plus Duration. Players may pool Tokens for one claim.

STAMINA IS THE BRAKE

Hold at most (Stamina $\times 3$) + 1. Make at most Stamina + 1 counted spends a Scene.

Only a Kotodama or a burned level of Corruption counts. The flat buys never do.

A character with Stamina 0 still holds 1 Token, and can spend it.

PLAYING INTO VULNERABILITY IS WHAT FUNDS THE CURRENCY.

20 BELOW KOTODAMA

SAY IT, PAY FOR IT, AND IT'S TRUE

1 MAGNITUDE

5 AND UP TAKES A POOLED GROUP, AND THE GM SETS THE COST

1	MINOR COINCIDENCE	The key is under the mat. The door didn't latch.
2	MEANINGFUL CHANGE	The stolen motorcycle is just around the corner.
3	DECISIVE FEAT	A patrol's morale breaks, all at once.
4	SOLO CEILING	A building that should be collapsing suddenly isn't.
5	PAST ANY ONE PERSON	Everyone who died in one fire is found alive.
6+	UNIVERSE-ALTERING	The dead of a war were never dead. Everyone remembers it so.

2 RANGE

HOW FAR IT HAS TO HOLD

SELF on your person	FREE	TOUCH arm's reach	FREE	IN SIGHT the vicinity	FREE	YOUR SPACE room, vehicle, block	FREE	ANYWHERE ELSE the GM prices it
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3 PLAUSIBILITY

WHO IS WATCHING SETS THE TIER

WHISPER Normal luck. A witness wouldn't think twice. <i>The door didn't latch.</i>	+0	MURMUR A stroke of luck a skeptic talks themselves out of. <i>Every camera pointed away.</i>	+1	SHOUT Breaks what anyone present believes possible. Remembered. <i>A vault door opens untouched.</i>	+3
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Alone in a stairwell it's a Whisper; in a crowded bar, a Shout. Nobody sees it at all: drop one tier.

4 DURATION

PERMANENT UNLESS YOU PAY

PERMANENT It just sticks.	FREE	TRANSIENT Once, then it unhappens.	+1	INTERMITTENT Comes and goes.	+2	CYCLIC On a dependable pattern.	+2
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5 ADDING IT UP

MAGNITUDE + RANGE + PLAUSIBILITY + DURATION

1	Your phone has signal down here	MAGNITUDE 1, WHISPER
3	The camera on this corner happened to point the other way	MAGNITUDE 2, MURMUR
4	The vault door swings open - empty building	MAGNITUDE 3, MURMUR
6	The vault door swings open - crowded lobby	MAGNITUDE 3, SHOUT
7	The building that should be coming down isn't	MAGNITUDE 4, SHOUT

The same vault door is a 4 or a 6, depending only on who's in the lobby. Clear the room first.

EACH CLAIM IS ONE SPEND TOWARD YOUR STAMINA + 1 A SCENE, AND EVERY TOKEN SPENT GOES TO THE GM'S POOL.

A THIN PLACE MAKES IT CHEAPER. EACH TOKEN OF GM HARDENING ADDS 1. A PAID-FOR CLAIM IS NEVER UNDONE.

20 BELOW

BOONS AND FLAWS

WHAT THEY COST, AND WHAT THEY PAY

1 BOONS

SMALL, PERMANENT PIECES OF GOOD LUCK

TRIVIAL	1	LESSER	3	GREATER	5	LEGENDARY	7
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NO BONUS TO A ROLL
TIERED BOONS
BOUGHT AGAIN
AT CREATION

LATER, WITH XP

A Boon is a rule exception, an unlocked option, or a standing fact about your body or name. A few come in two to four tiers. A higher tier includes every lower one, so buy only one. Special Movement is bought once for each way of moving it gives you. A 10-point Boons Pool. Unspent points become Discretionary, 1 for 1. Discretionary buys Boons at 2 for 1. Twice the creation cost: Trivial 2, Lesser 6, Greater 10, Legendary 14.

2 FLAWS

YOU MAKE IT HARDER. THE SYSTEM PAYS YOU FOR IT.

LEVEL 1	+1	LEVEL 2	+2	LEVEL 3	+3	LEVEL 4	+4	LEVEL 5	+5
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ONLY AT CREATION

NO EFFECT, NO POINTS
WHEN IT BITES

OVERCOME IT
SHED IT
SCARS

Every Flaw is taken at creation, in Levels 1 to 5. Its Level is the points it grants, and those points feed Discretionary. A Flaw that never makes anything harder for you isn't worth anything. Whoever invokes it, you or the GM, you get 1 Fate Token. One beat pays once, even if it fits your Nature too. 1 Fate Token, and the Flaw doesn't apply for the rest of the Scene. 3 XP per Level, one Level at a time. Buying it off also cuts your own Token income. Going below 0 in a Vital leaves a scar - one narrow effect, the GM's pick, permanent until healed.

3 EVERY WAY TO EARN A FATE TOKEN

HELD TO STAMINA X 3 + 1

NATURE
A FLAW BITES
VOLUNTARY DISADVANTAGE
SUNRISE
A MILESTONE
YOUR LUCKY NUMBER
THE GM'S CALL

Play to it at a dramatic moment, when it costs you.
You or the GM invokes one of your Flaws.
Take Disadvantage on a roll of your own choosing.
1 Token every day, for every character.
The group gets past something that mattered: 1 to every PC, about once a session.
A core roll that totals your Klothe. Automatic, once per roll.
Good roleplay, or a clever idea.

One moment pays one Token, however many of these it fits. A Token earned at your cap is lost, not banked.

BUY OFF A FLAW WHEN THE STORY HAS FINISHED WITH IT. NOT WHEN IT'S INCONVENIENT.
EVERY BOON AND FLAW IS LISTED IN THE BOOK, WITH WHAT EACH LEVEL OR TIER DOES.

20 BELOW KI

THE POOL YOU SPEND

1 WHAT KI IS

The pool that powers everything superhuman a character does. Not a Vital - the Vitals are taken from you, Ki is what you spend. Every spend is direct: no roll, no check, and none of them touch Stamina's per-Scene Fate Token cap.

YOUR POOL

TOP ELEMENT + 8

2 KI HAS EXACTLY THREE JOBS

A wall is a flat number the target simply has - Soak, Presence or Psyche. No roll, no spend. Every attack die is checked against it on its own. Boosting is how Ki pushes a die over one.

PRESERVE A LEVEL

1 KI

Cancels one Health, Poise or Sanity Level before it is lost.
Below 0, Poise or Sanity back to 1.
At 0 Sanity, a full refill.

BUMP A BRACKET

1 KI A STEP

Move up one Action Bracket.
Slow to Normal, Normal to Fast.
2 Ki moves two steps at once.

BOOST A DIE

1 KI A DIE

Adds your Ferocity, Presence or Psyche to that attack die.
Roll first, then choose - no Ki is ever wasted.

3 GIFTS

Most Gifts cost Ki, called out per Gift and per Level. Some also call for a Gift Check, rolled against your current Ki.

4 GETTING IT BACK

Short Rest restores Klotho Ki, minimum 1.
Full Night's Rest restores the pool completely.

5 RAISING THE POOL

One point of Ki costs XP equal to your current Ki. At 14 Ki, the next point is 14 XP. Sessions cap at 5 XP, so a single point is roughly three sessions of everything you earn. The ceiling is twice your figured Ki - 26 to 36 for most characters. Raising your strongest Element lifts the pool and the ceiling together.

EVERY CHARACTER SITS BETWEEN 13 AND 18. THE FRAIL SPECIALIST CHANNELS AS MUCH AS THE BRUISER.

20 BELOW USING A GIFT

ONE NARROW THING, FIVE LEVELS DEEP

1 FIVE LEVELS, CLIMBED IN ORDER

A Gift does one specific thing. Its Level is how big, how strong, how far.

1

>

2

>

3

>

4

>

5

Hold Level 2 before
you buy Level 3.

3 POINTS A LEVEL AT CREATION

2 THREE TOOLS, NONE OF THEM NEW

Each Gift, and each Level of it, says which it uses. Not every Gift uses all three.

A ROLL

BORROWED

Weapon damage, the Presence
or Psyche attack, or a plain
Attribute + Difficulty.

KI COST

A FLAT SPEND

No roll. Written into the
Level that charges it, like
bumping your Bracket.

GIFT CHECK

2D10 VS CURRENT KI

Meet your current Ki or
roll under it: free.
Fail, and it costs 1 Ki.

YOUR GIFT CHECK AS KI DRAINS

16 KI

90%

12 KI

64%

8 KI

28%

4 KI

6%

3 A GIFT THAT ATTACKS

Rolls its Level plus half the sub-stat that powers it, rounded down.

LEVEL + ½ SUB-STAT

DICE AGAINST SOAK

FEROCITY

DICE AGAINST PRESENCE

PRESENCE

DICE AGAINST PSYCHE

PSYCHE

Onslaught at Level 5, with Ferocity 4: $5 + 2 = 7$ dice. An ordinary weapon tops out at 5, forever.
A Gift is also the only way to make a mental attack.

4 MAKE IT YOUR OWN: ADDERS AND LIMITERS

Adders unlock an option for good: Lesser 3 points, Greater 6. Using it costs the Ki the Gift names. Limiters are restrictions you choose at creation: each one cuts every Level of that Gift by 1 point, and no Level ever drops below 1.

20
BELOW

THE RESOURCES LADDER

WHAT YOU HAVE, WHO YOU KNOW, AND WHAT PICKS UP WHEN YOU CALL

LEVEL

1

ONE PERSON. ONE PLACE. ONE THING.

One reliable contact. One bolt-hole. One lawyer who answers.

Wealth 1: rent, bills and daily needs covered without stress.

LEVEL

2

LOCAL, AND SOMEBODY OWES YOU.

A handful of contacts across a couple of fields. A block that knows you.

Wealth 2: real disposable income, savings that absorb an emergency.

LEVEL

3

CITYWIDE. ENOUGH TO CHANGE AN OUTCOME.

A network spanning most of a city. A district held and defended.

Wealth 3: property owned outright, major purchases made freely.

LEVEL

4

REGIONAL, WITH REAL NAMES IN IT.

Influential people owe you. Classified clearance. Charges vanish quietly.

Wealth 4: enough to finance a major undertaking outright.

LEVEL

5

NATIONAL OR BEYOND. YOU ARE THE INSTITUTION.

A fixture in the network, not a customer. Almost any door, anywhere.

Wealth 5: a fortune large enough to move markets.

PUSHING A RESOURCE

The Level is what you get free. To ask past it, roll 2d10 under Level + (10 - Index).

Resource Index is 1-6: how far past ordinary reach the ask goes. Lower is easier.

Success: you get it, no further cost. Failure: you get it anyway, and the Level drops 1.

Critical failure drops it 2. Drops are cumulative, and the lower Level is the real one.

Only six can be pushed: Contacts, Debts Owed, Media Contact, Occult Library, System Access, Wealth. Every other Resource is a standing fact, with nothing to roll.

SPENT, AND REACHING PAST IT

At Level 0 nothing can be drawn on it - free scope or roll - until the next Month starts.

You may reach up to 2 Index above your current Level, and no further.

Reaching that far works, and drops the Level to 0 for a Month whatever the dice said.

THE ASK ALWAYS GOES THROUGH. WHAT IT COSTS IS THE ABILITY TO MAKE THE NEXT ONE.

20 BELOW

THE RESOURCE INDEX

HOW FAR PAST WHAT YOU HAVE

1 LOWER IS EASIER

LEVEL + (10 - INDEX)

A flat 1 to 6 for how far past ordinary reach the ask goes.
It adds 10 minus the Index to your target, so the scale runs backwards.

2 WHAT THE INDEX ADDS TO YOUR TARGET



INDEX 6 ADDS THE LEAST, AND ALWAYS COUNTS AS REACHING PAST YOUR MEANS.

3 YOUR CHANCE, LEVEL BY INDEX

Meet the target or roll under it. Fail, and you still get it, but the Level drops 1.

	INDEX 1	INDEX 2	INDEX 3	INDEX 4	INDEX 5	INDEX 6
LEVEL 1	45%	REACH	REACH	—	—	—
LEVEL 2	55%	45%	REACH	REACH	—	—
LEVEL 3	64%	55%	45%	REACH	REACH	—
LEVEL 4	72%	64%	55%	45%	REACH	REACH
LEVEL 5	79%	72%	64%	55%	45%	REACH

REACH: YOU GET IT, AND THE RESOURCE DROPS TO 0 FOR A MONTH, UNLESS YOU ROLL A CRITICAL SUCCESS.

INDEX 6 ALWAYS DROPS IT TO 0, CRITICAL OR NOT. — : TOO FAR TO TRY.

ASKING AT YOUR OWN LEVEL IS ALWAYS 45%. EACH STEP DOWN ADDS 7 TO 10 POINTS.

20 BELOW ADVANCEMENT

EARN IT, THEN SPEND IT ON ANYTHING

1 EARNING XP

UP TO 5 A SESSION, PLUS STORY AWARDS

1 XP for each of these. It comes at the end of a session and is spent before the next one - no teacher, no downtime, no reason needed.

ATTENDANCE
& PARTICIPATION

GOOD
ROLEPLAYING

HEROISM
& RISK FACED

LEARNING
& DISCOVERY

STANDOUT
MOMENT

2 WHAT EVERYTHING COSTS

PAY FOR THE RUNG YOU'RE LEAVING

BUY	THE PRICE	STEP BY STEP
SKILLS	New: 3. Then current tier x 2.	3 → 2 → 4 → 6 = 15 to Master
RESOURCES	New: 4. Then current Level x 3.	4 → 3 → 6 → 9 → 12 = 34 to Level 5
GIFTS	New: 7. Then current Level x 5.	7 → 5 → 10 → 15 → 20 = 57. Each Limiter: -1
GIFT ADDERS	Flat, whenever you buy them.	Lesser 6, Greater 12
BOONS	Twice the creation cost.	Trivial 2, Lesser 6, Greater 10, Legendary 14
ATTRIBUTES	Current rating x 9.	5 to 6 is 45, 7 to 8 is 63, 9 to 10 is 81
KI	Your current Ki, a point at a time.	Up to twice your figured Ki
SHED A FLAW	3x the points it granted.	One Level at a time, if it has Levels

3 WHAT A SESSION BUYS

AT ABOUT 4 XP A SESSION

ONE SESSION

A new Skill	3
Trained to Adept	2
A new Resource	4

TWO OR THREE

A new Gift	7
A Greater Boon	10

FOUR SESSIONS

A Skill to Master	15
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A SEASON OR MORE

A Gift, 1 to 5	50
Attribute 5 to 6	45
Attribute 7 to 8	63

4 PAST TEN

TEN TO ELEVEN IS 90 XP

Ten is a creation cap, not a ceiling. XP takes an Attribute higher, but an Element never adds more than 10 to a roll. Every point is still a sub-stat point and a Descriptor, and at 20 both sub-stats are full.

EVERY 3 PAST 10

+1 to your Fate Token ceiling.
Stacks across Attributes.

EVERY 4 PAST 10

One automatic success a scene
with that Element, at Difficulty 6
or better.

EVERY 5 PAST 10

+1 to your critical band on any roll
with that Element.

NO CLASSES, NO LEVELS. SPEND IT ON WHATEVER YOU LIKE, IN ANY ORDER.

20 BELOW THE ROUND

DECLARE, THEN RESOLVE BAND BY BAND

1 INITIATIVE, ONCE

Rolled at the start of the fight and never again. Higher total acts first. That order holds for every round until the fight ends.

1d10 + INT

2 DECLARE A BAND, EVERY ROUND

FAST

REACTIVE

1 ACTION

ACTS FIRST

A move, an attack, or one Skill use. That is the whole turn. You go before anyone slower can act against you.

NORMAL

ACTIVE

2 ACTIONS

ACTS SECOND

A move and an attack, or any two things you could do. The balanced middle: volume, and a middling place in line.

SLOW

MEASURED

1 ACTION

ACTS LAST

One empowered action: Aim, a Called Shot, Study a Target - plus a 1m step either side. All spellcasting is Slow.

3 RESOLVE IN ORDER

FAST

NORMAL

SLOW

Inside a band, highest Initiative first.

BUY SPEED

1 Ki moves you up one band.
2 Ki moves you up both.

4 ACTIONS

THE FULL LIST IS ON THE ACTIONS SHEET

DASH	NORMAL	Both actions on movement. 2x Movement Rate, nothing else.
SPRINT	SLOW	Moving and nothing else. 5x Rate. Ki can bump it to Normal or Fast.
DIVE FOR COVER	FAST	Move at once, land Belly Down. Normal: a full move, then the dive.
RECKLESS	FREE	Advantage on your attacks this round - and on theirs against you.
ATTACK ON THE RUN	FAST	A full move and an attack, anywhere along it, at Disadvantage.
FULL DEFENSE	NORMAL	No attack. Theirs at Disadvantage, and your Defense drops 4.
RELOAD	VARIES	One action for most. A Slow action shell by shell. Bows are free.

FAST BUYS POSITION. NORMAL BUYS VOLUME. SLOW BUYS POWER.

20 BELOW ACTIONS

WHAT A ROUND CAN BUY

1 SLOW: ONE EMPOWERED ACTION

ONE PER ROUND

A Slow round is one of these, plus a 1m step before or after it.

AIM	Advantage on the attack.
CALLED SHOT	Hit something specific: a hand, a strap, a weapon, a Zone. No Advantage.
STUDY A TARGET	No roll. Your next attack on it, next round, has Advantage.
CAREFUL WORK	Advantage on a Skill roll. It carries on for the same task until you're interrupted.
BRACE	Until your next turn you can't be Bulldozed, shoved or knocked Prone.
BULLDOZE	Charge 5m to 2x your Movement Rate, then your Potence in d10s against its Soak. Each die over pushes it back 1m and you take the space.
SPELLCASTING	Always Slow, once magic exists.

Aim and a Called Shot don't combine, but Study a Target gives next round's Called Shot Advantage. Distracted: the action drops to Normal and loses its empowerment.

2 SPECIAL ACTIONS

EACH ONLY IN THE BAND IT NAMES

ATTACK ON THE RUN	FAST	A full move and an attack anywhere along it, at Disadvantage.
SNAP TO COVER	FAST	A 1m step into adjacent cover, staying on your feet.
DIVE FOR COVER	FAST OR NORMAL	Fast: your Movement Rate at once, landing Belly Down. Normal: a full move, then the dive.
SPRINT	SLOW	5x your Movement Rate and nothing else. Ki can bump it.

3 COMBAT ACTIONS

SPEND YOUR BAND'S ACTIONS

Fast has one action, Normal two. A move, an attack or a Skill use is one each.

DASH	NORMAL	Both actions on movement: 2x your Movement Rate.
RECKLESS	FREE	Advantage on your attacks this round, and on attacks against you.
FULL DEFENSE	NORMAL	No attacking. Attacks on you are at Disadvantage and your Defense drops by 4, to no lower than 0. Your other action can be a move.
GRAB	1 ACTION	From Melee: an attack roll, then your Potence in d10s against its Soak. Any die over, and it's Grabbed.
DISARM	CALLED SHOT	At a held weapon or item. On a hit, Potence against Potence knocks it loose. Gauntlets give the defender Advantage.
HELP	1 ACTION	An ally's next roll has Advantage. You must reach them, or their task.
READY	1 ACTION	Name a trigger. The action resolves when it happens.
RELOAD	BY WEAPON	Magazine, speed-loader or crossbow crank: 1 action. A tube-fed shotgun: a full Slow action. A bow from a quiver: free.
SMALL ACTIONS	1 ACTION	Draw, swap or stow a weapon, or use a simple item.
BELLY DOWN	FREE	Flat on purpose. Standing up, or recovering from Prone, is 1 action.
ESCAPE A HOLD	CONTEST	Against the grabber's Potence, or a grip's Hardness.

A GIFT OR WEAPON THAT STATES ITS OWN ACTION COST ALWAYS WINS.
1 KI BUMPS YOUR BAND ONE STEP. 2 KI TAKES SLOW STRAIGHT TO FAST.

20 BELOW THE COMBAT FLOW

INITIATIVE ONCE, THEN EVERY ROUND THE SAME

1 INITIATIVE, ONCE

Roll at the start of the fight and never again.
Higher total acts first, every round until it ends.

1d10 + INIT

2 DECLARE A BAND

Every round, before anyone acts.
Fast buys position. Normal buys volume. Slow buys power.

FAST

NORMAL

SLOW

3 ACT IN BAND ORDER

Fast, then Normal, then Slow.
Inside a band, highest Initiative goes first.

4 ROLL TO HIT

Target: attacker's Attribute + the defender's Defense as the Difficulty.
Roll 2d10. Meet it or roll under it, and it hits.

2d10

MISS

OVER THE TARGET: NOTHING HAPPENS

HIT

ROLL THE DAMAGE DICE

5 RESOLVE EACH DIE

Every die on its own, against the defender's wall:
Soak, Presence or Psyche, whichever the attack meets.

DIE ≤ WALL

ABSORBED, NO EFFECT

DIE > WALL

CONNECTS: LOSE ONE LEVEL

HEALTH, POISE OR SANITY - WHICHEVER FITS THE ATTACK

ORDER ONCE. EVERYTHING AFTER, ONE DIE AT A TIME.

20
BELOW

MAKING AN ATTACK

YOUR APPROACH, THEIR DEFENSE, YOUR DICE

1 YOUR APPROACH PICKS THE ELEMENT

Not your weapon. Say how you attack before you roll, and the GM confirms it.

EARTH

FORCE

AIR

PRECISION

FIRE

INTENSITY

WATER

ADAPTATION

MOIRA

SOCIAL & MENTAL ONLY

2 YOUR ELEMENT + THEIR DEFENSE

That's the target. Roll 2d10. Meet it or roll under it, and the hit lands.

ELEMENT + DEFENSE

PHYSICAL DEFENSE

10 - ATROPOS

SOCIAL DEFENSE

10 - PSYCHE

MENTAL DEFENSE

10 - PRESENCE

3 A FISTFUL OF DICE

On a hit, roll damage dice, all at once. How many depends on what you hit with.

WEAPON

DAMAGE RATING

Fists roll 1, a knife 3.
Ordinary weapons top out
at 5. Special ones, more.

GIFT

LEVEL + ½ SUB-STAT

Rounded down. Ferocity,
Presence or Psyche,
whichever it attacks with.

SOCIAL

TRAINING TIER

UNTRAINED	1	TRAINED	3
ADEPT	4	EXPERT	5
MASTER	6		

4 THEN EVERY DIE MEETS A WALL

Each die on its own. Over the wall costs a Level. Taking Damage has the rest.

PHYSICAL → SOAK

EACH HIT COSTS 1 HEALTH

SOCIAL → PRESENCE

EACH HIT COSTS 1 POISE

MENTAL → PSYCHE

EACH HIT COSTS 1 SANITY

MENTAL ATTACKS TAKE A GIFT. NOTHING ELSE CAN MAKE ONE.

THE ELEMENT IS HOW YOU DO IT. THE DICE ARE WHAT YOU DO IT WITH.

20 BELOW TAKING DAMAGE

HIT, THEN EVERY DIE, THEN WHAT IT COSTS

1 TO HIT

Attacker's Attribute + target's Defense as the Difficulty. Roll 2d10 under it.
No Skill. Defense is 10 - Atropos. A miss ends it here.

2d10

2 THE CATEGORY PICKS THE WALL, AND THE WALL PICKS THE COST

A wall is a flat number you simply have - Soak, Presence or Psyche. No roll, no spend, no action.
Earth sets Soak, Fire sets Presence, Air sets Psyche. It is the number every incoming die has to beat.

PHYSICAL

DICE MEET

SOAK

EACH HIT COSTS

1 HEALTH

SOCIAL

DICE MEET

PRESENCE

EACH HIT COSTS

1 POISE

MENTAL

DICE MEET

PSYCHE

EACH HIT COSTS

1 SANITY

3 EVERY DIE, ON ITS OWN

The attack throws its dice. Each one is checked against the wall by itself.

WALL
6

3

SOAKED

5

SOAKED

6

SOAKED

9

1 LEVEL

10

1 LEVEL

Die **equal to or under** the wall is absorbed. **Over** it connects.

OR SPEND 1 KI ON THAT DIE

5

+

FEROCITY

4

=

9

1 LEVEL

Roll first, then choose. No Ki is ever wasted.

4 SPEND KI

Infuse - after the roll, 1 Ki a die adds your Ferocity / Presence / Psyche to that die.
Preserve - 1 Ki cancels 1 Level, after the hit.

5 ON A CRITICAL

Half the attack's dice, rounded up, connect with no roll and no wall at all.
The rest roll, each adding your Klotho free of charge - and Ki still stacks on top.

A WALL OF 10 STOPS AN UNBOOSTED DIE EVERY TIME.

20
BELOW

WEAPONS & ARMOR

HOW MANY DICE, AND WHAT STOPS THEM

1 DAMAGE IS HOW MANY DICE

A weapon's Damage is the number of d10 it rolls on a hit. It never grows.

1

DIE
FISTS
FEET

2

DICE
BRASS KNUCKLES
DERRINGER

3

DICE
KNIFE
COMPACT PISTOL

4

DICE
MACHETE
HUNTING RIFLE

5

DICE
CHAINSAW
LONGBOW

5+

SPECIAL WEAPONRY
ENERGY RIFLE 6
OR THE GM'S CALL

2 NORMAL / LONG RANGE

Every ranged weapon lists two numbers in meters, like a heavy revolver's 15m / 40m.

WITHIN NORMAL

NO PENALTY

OUT TO LONG

DISADVANTAGE

BEYOND LONG

CAN'T BE MADE

3 ARMOR TAKES THE DICE FIRST

While it has Health Levels left, armor meets every die before your Soak does.

DIE ≤ HARDNESS

DEFLECTED. NO COST TO ANYONE.

DIE > HARDNESS

STILL STOPPED. THE ARMOR LOSES A LEVEL.

Never more than 1 armor Level per attack, however many dice beat its Hardness.

At 0 Levels it's broken: dice go straight to your Soak until it's repaired.

Ki can preserve your Levels, never the armor's.

EXAMPLE: A TACTICAL VEST, HARDNESS 5, 3 LEVELS, TAKES 3, 5, 8, 9: TWO DEFLECTED, THE VEST LOSES 1.

4 FOUR ZONES, ONE PIECE EACH

Armor doesn't stack: one item per Zone. One item can cover several, like plate armor over the Center of Mass, Arms and Legs.

CENTER OF MASS

EVERY NORMAL ATTACK
VEST, COAT, SHIELD

HEAD

CALLED SHOT, SLOW ACTION
HELMET

ARMS

CALLED SHOT, SLOW ACTION
GAUNTLETS

LEGS

CALLED SHOT, SLOW ACTION
GREAVES

20
BELOW

RANGE & MOVEMENT

MAP OR NO MAP: ONE HEX IS ONE METRE.

1 FOUR BANDS

WEAPON REACH, TARGETING, SPOTTING

MELEE

CONTACT TO 1 M

Arm's reach.
A fist, a knife, a
hand on your collar.

A BAT REACHES HERE.

CLOSE

1 TO 10 M

The same room.
Across a bar, the
width of an alley.

A SHOTGUN IS BUILT FOR IT.

NEAR

10 TO 50 M

Across a street, the length
of a corridor, the far side
of a car park.

A HANDGUN REACHES 15 M.

FAR

BEYOND 50 M

Rooftop to rooftop.
The far end of a
warehouse.

A HUNTING RIFLE, 100 M.

The bar is not to scale. Metres without a map, hexes on one; the band follows.

2 HOW FAR YOU GET

Worked below for Air 3, so a Rate of 8 metres.

MOVEMENT RATE

5 + AIR, IN METRES

ONE MOVE

RATE

8 M

A Fast action's whole turn, or
the move half of a Normal.

DOUBLE MOVE

RATE X 2

16 M

Dash. Both Normal actions
spent on the ground.

SPRINT

RATE X 5

40 M

A Slow action, and the only
thing you do that round.

One move carries you out of Melee and into Close. A double move reaches Near.

3 WHAT SLOWS YOU

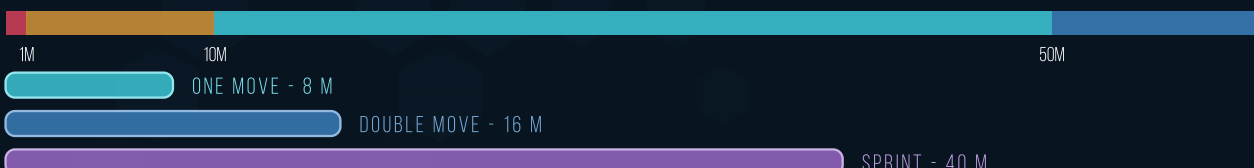
Rough ground costs 2 m for every 1 m,
Wild Land 3. An Athletics roll at 6 helps.
Crawling costs double. Exhausted 3
halves your Rate. Grabbed stops it.

4 WEAPONS AND BANDS

Every weapon lists Normal and Long range
in the same metres.
Its Normal range is the band it was built
for. Past that, you are reaching.

5 AND NOW TO SCALE

ONE ROUND OF GROUND, AT AIR 3



MAP OR NO MAP, THE CALL MEANS THE SAME THING AT EVERY TABLE.

20 BELOW GETTING AROUND

COVER, GROUND, WALLS AND WATER

1 LEAVING MELEE

YOU CAN ALWAYS MOVE AWAY

No free attack, no roll. Leaving costs time: anything that hasn't acted yet and declared Normal follows, and attacks if its move reaches you.

GO EARLY

Fast resolves before Normal and Slow.

GET FAR ENOUGH

End beyond its Movement Rate.

DON'T SPRINT

A Sprint goes last unless bumped.

MOVING PAST PEOPLE

Through an ally's space

Yes

Through an enemy's space

No. Go around.

End in an occupied space

Never - except Bulldoze

Passing beside an enemy

Costs nothing

Grabbed: Movement Rate 0. Escape first.

2 COVER

THE GM CALLS THE GRADE

FULL COVER

Attacks that need to see or reach you can't.

PARTIAL COVER

A corner, a car door, a low wall. Attacks against you: Disadvantage.

COVER WEARS DOWN

Shoot it as an item, where that's plausible. At 0 Health Levels it's gone.

3 TERRAIN AND FOOTING

WHAT A METER COSTS

CLEAR

1m per 1m

A floor, a road, a lawn

ROUGH

2m per 1m

Mud, deep snow, rubble, brush

WILD LAND

3m per 1m

Bog, ruins, thicket, deep drifts

PUSH THROUGH

Athletics 6, once a turn: Rough counts as Clear, Wild Land as Rough. Never better.

FOOTING

Ice or scree: a Dash, Sprint or Bulldoze needs Athletics 6, or you're Prone.

TIGHT SPACES

2m per 1m. You can't attack, and attacks against you are at Disadvantage.

4 CLIMB, JUMP, SWIM

ATHLETICS, EXCEPT WHERE IT SAYS WATER

CLIMB

One roll a turn. Success: full rate. Failure: 2m per 1m. A 20: you fall.

10

A stepladder, a low wall

9

A ladder

8

A low-branched tree, a fence

7

A knotted rope

6

Good holds, a drainpipe

5

A plain rope, crumbling brick

4

Rough stone; a rope, carrying

3

An overhang, a crumbling cliff

2

A sheer, rain-slick cliff

1

Smooth concrete, bare ice

0

Vertical glass

Rain, wind or dark: a step or two harder.

JUMP

Running long jump

Your Air, in m

Standing long jump

Half your Air

High jump

Half the long jump

No roll; it counts against your move.

Farther than your Air takes

Athletics:

+1M

+2M

+3M

+4M

+5M

8

6

4

2

0

Fall short and you land at your Air distance. Beside an edge, Athletics 6 and you're hanging on.

SWIM

Needs the Swimming Skill, or deep water starts the No-air clock unless you hold something that floats. Swim at your Movement Rate.

CALM

STARTS AT 8

Stamina Hours free, then Water + Difficulty once an hour.

ROUGH

STARTS AT 6

Stamina Minutes free, then Water + Difficulty once a minute.

The Difficulty drops 1 each roll, and each failure is a level of Exhausted. Exhausted 5 and you go under.

A CREATURE'S LISTED SWIM, CLIMB OR FLY IS ITS RATE: NO COST, NO ROLL - UNLESS YOU CHANGED THE GROUND.

20 BELOW

CHASES AND TRAVEL

HOW FAR, HOW FAST, HOW TIRED

1 THE CHASE ROUND

ORDINARY MOVEMENT, WITH A ROLL FOR THE ROUTE

1 DECLARE

A move, a Dash or a Sprint, as usual. A Sprint can be bumped with Ki.

2 CHASE ROLL

Everyone, Difficulty 6: Athletics on foot, or Driving, or Piloting. Being faster gives no Advantage.

3 RESOLVE

One side fails: it moves at half. Both succeed or both fail: full moves. A critical: 1.5x.

4 CHECK THE GAP

1m or less: caught, and it's Melee. Out of sight: broken away, for now.

HOW FAR A ROUND GOES

MOVE

1x

DASH

2x

SPRINT

5x

MOVEMENT RATE = 5 + AIR

The GM can make the roll a step or two harder for the route; gear that helps counts.

2 LOSING THEM

OUT OF SIGHT ISN'T GONE

The GM sets where sight breaks as the chase goes. Then the quarry rolls Stealth against the pursuer's Perception - on a creature's card, "Perception 7 vs. Stealth".

SUCCESS

They've lost it.

FAILURE

It's back on their trail, at the edge of sight.

YOU'RE CHASING?

Roll Perception or Tracking against the quarry's Stealth.

3 RUNNING IS EXHAUSTING

A SPRINT IS FLAT OUT

FREE FOR

Stamina Rounds of running flat out.

THEN EACH ROUND

Water + Difficulty, starting at 6 and dropping by 1.

EACH FAILURE

A level of Exhausted. Exhausted 1: Chase rolls at Disadvantage.

4 TRAVEL

OFF THE MAP, UNTIL IT TURNS INTO A SCENE

PACE

3 + Air/5 km per hour on clear ground.

TRAVEL DAY

4 + Stamina hours of walking.

A GROUP

Moves at its slowest member's pace, and stops when its shortest day runs out.

BAD GROUND

Rough halves the distance, Wild Land cuts it to a third. No roll.

FORCED MARCH

Past your day: Water + Difficulty each extra Hour, starting at 7 and dropping by 1. A level of Exhausted per failure; a Full Night's Rest clears it.

GETTING LOST

Only when the GM calls for it: roll Navigation. A compass and a map mean no roll.

CHARACTER

PACE

TRAVEL DAY

A DAY'S WALK

Air 1, Stamina 1

3.2 km/h

5 hours

16 km

Air 5, Stamina 3

4.0 km/h

7 hours

28 km

Air 10, Stamina 5

5.0 km/h

9 hours

45 km

THEATER OF THE MIND: THE GM KEEPS THE GAP IN METERS. ON A MAP: TRACK IT WHILE IT FITS, THEN ON PAPER.

20 BELOW THE VITALS

WHAT IT COSTS WHEN A DIE GETS THROUGH

1 ALL THREE RUN THE SAME TRACK

THE FLOOR



FULL

Each Vital is 5 plus its sub-stat, counted in Levels rather than points. A Level absorbs one hit, once. The row below zero mirrors the row above it. Whatever it took to put you down, it takes that much again.

2 WHAT WAITS AT EACH END

HEALTH

5 + HEALTH

SPENT BY PHYSICAL

AT 0

Unconscious.
Out of the fight.

BELOW 0

Dying, but no worse
on its own.

AT THE FLOOR

Dead. Minus your full
Health is the end.

POISE

5 + PRESENCE

SPENT BY SOCIAL

AT 0

Flustered.

BELOW 0

Humiliated.
Never fatal on its own.

AT THE FLOOR

Resets to 0, and you
take 1 Sanity - no wall.

SANITY

5 + PSYCHE

SPENT BY MENTAL

AT 0

Overwhelmed. A scar
effect, Disadvantage.

BELOW 0

Shattered. Led or
dragged, cannot act.

AT THE FLOOR

A scar effect, and
Sanity resets to 0.

3 CROSSING ZERO

One attack can never carry you past 0. Extra dice are discarded; you land exactly there. Already at 0, any further attack takes 1 Level total, however many dice connect.

4 GETTING IT BACK

Short Rest: the sub-stat halved, round up, min 1. A full night restores all of it. Dying, a Fate Token puts you at 1; stabilized, you're at 0. Below 0 Poise or Sanity, a rest or 1 Ki: back to 1.

5 WHAT A CROSSING LEAVES

Reaching 0 leaves a permanent mark with no mechanical effect - a scar, a tic, a reputation. Going below 0 leaves a scar: one narrow effect, the GM's pick, permanent until it's healed. One scar per crossing, and they accumulate. A Social scar can't be healed - it has to be rebuilt.

EVERY POINT IS WORTH TWO HITS. ONE BEFORE YOU DROP, ONE AFTER.

20 BELOW STATUS EFFECTS

WHAT IT DOES, AND HOW IT ENDS

FROM A ROLL

OFF BALANCE

Everything you roll is at Disadvantage.

ENDS END OF YOUR NEXT TURN. NEVER OFF BALANCE REROLLS THE FAILURE.

DISTRACTED

Roll Atropos + Difficulty or your Slow action drops to Normal.

ENDS WITH THAT ROLL.

SURPRISED

Disadvantage on everything, readiness included.

ENDS WHEN THE ROUND DOES.

STAGGERED

Your declared Bracket drops a step. Fast to Normal, Normal to Slow.

ENDS 1 KI A STEP, OR END OF YOUR NEXT TURN.

FROM A VITAL AT ZERO

FLUSTERED

At 0 Poise. Disadvantage on Social rolls and anything needing composure.

ENDS PRESENCE + DIFFICULTY TO SHAKE IT, OR THE SCENE.

HUMILIATED

Below 0 Poise. You cannot take the lead, negotiate, or speak for the group.

ENDS POISE RESTORED TO 0.

OVERWHELMED

At 0 Sanity. A temporary scar effect and Disadvantage, but you still act.

ENDS AWAY FROM THE CAUSE AND RESTED, OR 1 KI.

SHATTERED

Below 0 Sanity. You cannot act unaided and have to be led.

ENDS A REST OR 1 KI. BACK TO 1.

UNCONSCIOUS, THEN DYING

Out cold at 0 Health. Below it you are Dying, but it doesn't get worse on its own.

ENDS A FATE TOKEN: BACK AT 1. STABILIZED: AT 0.

FROM THE WORLD

EXHAUSTED

Five cumulative levels. The only condition that stacks.

ENDS A SHORT REST CLEARS ONE, A NIGHT CLEARS ALL.

BLINDED

Disadvantage on anything needing sight. No eye contact, in either direction.

ENDS WITH WHATEVER CAUSED IT.

DEAFENED

Disadvantage on anything needing hearing. You can still speak.

ENDS WITH WHATEVER CAUSED IT.

GRABBED

Movement Rate 0, and Disadvantage on all but escape or the grabber.

ENDS CONTESTED AGAINST THE GRABBER'S POTENCE.

PRONE

You can't attack, and every attack against you gains Advantage.

ENDS ONE ACTION TO RECOVER.

FRIGHTENED

Disadvantage against the source, and you cannot willingly close on it.

ENDS OUT OF SIGHT OF IT, OR THE SCENE.

ENVENOMED

Disadvantage on Physical rolls, and a rest will not clear it.

ENDS A DAILY WATER + 8 ROLL, OR ANTITOXIN. NEVER KI.

BLEEDING

1 die against Soak at the end of every round.

ENDS A NORMAL ACTION TO STEM IT, OR A GIFT.

TRUE OF ALL OF THEM

A Fate Token shrugs any of them off for a moment.

Only Exhausted comes in levels. The rest are on or off.

No penalties. Only Advantage and Disadvantage.

EVERY CONDITION NAMES ITS OWN WAY OUT.

20 BELOW SCARS

WHAT GOING BELOW 0 LEAVES BEHIND

1 WHAT A CROSSING LEAVES

ONE PER CROSSING

AT 0	A mark that's only for show: a scar or a limp from Health, a nervous habit from Poise, a tic from Sanity. Healing and Regeneration stop the Health one entirely.
BELOW 0	A scar: one narrow, lasting effect. Health leaves a Physical scar, Poise a Social one, Sanity a Mental one. The GM picks, or you agree it together.
STACKING	One scar per crossing. Heal back up and go below again for another. Going deeper in one fall doesn't add a second, and no scar twice.
NOT A FLAW	A scar gives no points, and one getting in your way never earns a Fate Token. It's permanent until something heals it.

2 HEALING A SCAR

COUNT HOW FAR BELOW 0 YOU WENT

SCAR	BY GIFT	BY ADDER	BY SKILL
PHYSICAL	Healing or Regeneration: Days	-	Medicine: Months
MENTAL	Restoration: Days	Talking Down, Taking the Edge Off: Weeks	Psychology: Months
SOCIAL	-	-	Networking: Months

-7 below 0 is seven of them. A Skill takes regular work from someone Trained in it - for Networking, that's you. A scarred reputation can't be treated or healed - it has to be rebuilt.

3 PHYSICAL SCARS

FROM HEALTH

Bad Knee Movement Rate -1m. Disadvantage on Athletics to jump.

Stiff Shoulder Disadvantage on Thrown Weapons and Archery.

Shaky Hand Disadvantage on Sleight of Hand, and on Firearms past Close.

Ribs That Set Wrong Your Stamina baseline for holding breath and running flat-out is halved.

Ringling Ear Disadvantage on Perception by sound.

Clouded Eye Disadvantage on Perception by sight past Close.

Weak Grip Disadvantage on Potence contests to hold on: grapples, climbing, a hand on a ledge.

Missing Fingers Disadvantage on Crafting, Electronics and Security by hand.

Limp Disadvantage on Acrobatics, and in chases on foot.

Scarred Lungs Disadvantage on endurance checks in smoke, cold or thin air.

Weather in the Joints In cold or rain, Disadvantage on Athletics and Acrobatics.

Tender Spot Ki can't preserve the first Health Level you lose in a Scene.

Disfigured Disadvantage on Disguise. People who've seen you once remember you.

Bad Back Disadvantage on Athletics to lift, carry or drag.

Slow to Clot First Aid and Medicine on you are at Disadvantage.

Night Blind Disadvantage on Perception and Driving in the dark.

Chronic Pain Your baseline for any sustained exertion is one unit shorter.

Burn Scars Soak counts 1 lower against fire and heat.

Old Break A hit that costs 2 or more Health Levels also leaves you Off Balance.

Wheeze Disadvantage on Stealth when you've moved this round.

SOCIAL AND MENTAL SCARS OVERLEAF.

20 BELOW SCARS

SOCIAL AND MENTAL

4 SOCIAL SCARS

FROM POISE - REBUILT, NEVER HEALED

The Story Goes Around Disadvantage on Intimidation against anyone who's heard what happened.

Known Face Disadvantage on Disguise and Stealth where it happened.

Stammer Disadvantage on Public Speaking and Performance in front of an audience.

Sore Spot A Social attack that brings it up gets 1 extra die.

Burned Bridge Disadvantage on Networking with one Contact or faction who saw it.

Eyes Down Disadvantage on Leadership when the person who did it is present.

Tell Insight to read you is at Advantage.

Gives Ground Disadvantage on Barter and Bribery.

Rattled Losing a Poise Level leaves you Distracted.

The Nickname Ridicule that uses it is at Advantage against you.

Out of Place Disadvantage on Etiquette at anything formal.

It's on Video Once a session the GM can say someone in the Scene has seen it. Disadvantage on Persuasion with them.

Can't Let It Go When it's thrown at you in public, Disadvantage on everything else until you answer it.

Nervous Laugh Disadvantage on Charm and Seduction when it matters.

Quiet Voice Disadvantage on Intimidation.

Flushes Disadvantage on Deception about yourself.

Won't Ask You can't be Helped on Social rolls.

On the Record Disadvantage on Bureaucracy and Law wherever the record exists.

Stage Freeze Your first Social roll in front of a crowd each Scene is at Disadvantage.

Touchy Subject Ki can't preserve Poise against a Social attack that brings it up.

5 MENTAL SCARS

FROM SANITY

The Trigger One sound, smell or sight leaves you Distracted when it turns up.

Night Terrors A Full Night's Rest refills Ki only as a Short Rest does (Klotho), unless somebody keeps watch with you.

Hypervigilant You can't be Surprised, and you can't take a Short Rest anywhere unsecured.

Phobia Disadvantage on every roll while the thing is within Close.

Lost Time A stretch of memory is gone. The GM knows what's in it.

Intrusive Memory A catastrophic failure also leaves you Distracted.

Checks the Exits Your first action in each Scene is at Slow.

Flat Disadvantage on Performance and Charm.

Paranoid You can't be Helped by anyone you haven't known a Month.

Startle A sudden loud noise costs you Fast for the round.

Drifts Once a session the GM can say you drift. Disadvantage on Perception for that Scene.

Insomnia Miss a Full Night's Rest and you wake Exhausted.

The Voice You answer it under your breath. Disadvantage on Stealth.

Survivor's Guilt While an ally is Dying, you can't spend a Fate Token on yourself.

Freezes Surprised lasts a round longer.

Tunnel Vision Under Mental attack, you can't Help or be Helped.

It Knows You Mental attacks from the thing that did it get 1 extra die.

The Dark Disadvantage on every roll in darkness without a light.

Fixated While it's in the Scene, Disadvantage on anything that isn't about it.

Cracks Disadvantage on Academics, Research and Law in combat.

6 NONE OF THESE FIT?

MAKE ONE

Your GM can make one. Tie it to the moment, keep it narrow - a Skill or two, one trigger, an extra die, a small cut to a Rest or a Bracket - and have it bite about once a session. Never every roll, a lost stat point, fewer Health Levels, or anything that ends the character.

A SCAR COMES FROM ONE MOMENT. ANYONE AT THE TABLE CAN POINT TO IT.

20 BELOW HAZARDS

NO ATTACKER, THE SAME DICE

1 THE WORLD ROLLS AGAINST YOUR SOAK

Each die over your Soak costs a Health Level. The weapon table is the scale.

FALLING

1 DIE PER 4M, 5 MAX
HALVED INTO WATER OR SNOW

BURNING ROOM

1 DIE PER ROUND
UNTIL YOU GET OUT

ON FIRE

2 DICE PER ROUND
PUT OUT: A NORMAL ACTION

VEHICLE

1 DIE PER 10 MPH / 16 KM/H
NO CAP. ONE HIT STOPS AT 0

2 NO AIR, NOTHING TO SOAK

Drowning, smoke, suffocation. Armor is no help here.

HOLD YOUR BREATH: STAMINA ROUNDS



THEN 1 HEALTH PER ROUND. NO DICE.

3 COLD AND HEAT COST EXHAUSTED, NOT HEALTH

Dressed for the cold, nothing happens. No level clears while you're still in it.

UNDERDRESSED FOR COLD
1 PER HOUR

WET, WINDY OR -20°
1 PER HALF HOUR

IN COLD WATER
1 PER MINUTE

HARD WORK IN REAL HEAT
1 PER HOUR

NO WATER, WHATEVER YOU DO
1 PER HOUR

ENCLOSED, AIRLESS HEAT
1 PER HALF HOUR

EXHAUSTED 5 IS UNCONSCIOUS · WITHOUT WATER, NOTHING CLEARS UNTIL YOU DRINK

4 VENOM AND GAS LEAVE YOU ENVENOMED

Disadvantage on Physical rolls. No rest clears it, and Ki can't end it.

DAILY: WATER + 8
ONE SUCCESS ENDS IT

ANTITOXIN
ALWAYS ENDS IT

MEDICINE
ADVANTAGE ON THE DAILY ROLL

A MASK
STOPS GAS AND SPORES

5 CORRUPTION

One track, whatever the locus. Any die over your Klotho adds a level, one at a time.

Burn 1 Fate Token per level, 1-4 - each is a counted spend. The pull stays a week per day at 2+.

**1
TELL**

OTHERS SEE A SIGN
24 HOURS AWAY

**2
PULL**

YOU WANT TO GO BACK
1 LEVEL PER 24 HOURS

**3
MARKED**

A MARK THAT SPREADS
ITS LOCUS'S CURE

**4
CONDUIT**

YOU THIN REALITY
DESTROY OR SEAL IT

**5
CLAIMED**

IT HAS YOU
KOTODAMA, 6+ FATE